

1. Pseudo-Classes (:)

Pseudo-classes define **special states** of elements — things like hover, focus, first child, etc.

Commonly Used

Pseudo-class	Example	Purpose
:hover	a:hover { color: red; }	Styles an element when hovered
:active	button:active { transform: scale(0.98); }	Styles when element is clicked
:focus	input:focus { border-color: blue; }	Styles when input is focused
:visited	a:visited { color: purple; }	Styles visited links
:first-child	p:first-child { font-weight: bold; }	Styles the first child of its parent
:last-child	p:last-child { color: gray; }	Styles the last child of its parent
:nth-child(n)	li:nth-child(2) { color: red; }	Styles a specific child index
:not(selector)	p:not(.highlight) { color: black; }	Styles elements not matching selector
:checked	input:checked { background: green; }	Styles checked checkboxes/radio buttons
:disabled	input:disabled { opacity: 0.5; }	Styles disabled inputs

2. Pseudo-Elements (::)

Pseudo-element	Example	Purpose
::before	.box::before { content: "★ "; color: gold; }	Inserts content before an element
::after	.box::after { content: " ✓"; color: green; }	Inserts content after an element
::first-letter	p::first-letter { font-size: 2em; }	Styles first letter of text

Pseudo-element	Example	Purpose
::first-line	p::first-line { color: blue; }	Styles the first line of text
::selection	::selection { background: yellow; }	Styles text selection background